

CMP5354

Software Design

D3

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+PitchingTips: List<String>

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D3 -- Refer to *Assessment Brief*

D3 Assessment Context

Linking Assessment to Final Year Project

Assessment Brief

Assessment Information	
Assessment Task (with genre/type)	Poster + Viva This assessment comprises two parts: a project poster that visually summarises your project outcomes, and an oral defence. You will present your work in a formal setting, such as Innovation Fest, demonstrating your ability to effectively communicate the project outcomes and defend your work. The oral defence aims to assess your understanding of the problem, design choices, implementation challenges, evaluation, and overall project management.

What skills do you need to build towards that?

- Professional communication
- Presentation Skills
- Showcasing functionality and quality
- Defending design decisions
- Demonstrating field knowledge

Slide Structure and Tips

Problem	What is the relevance and impact of the problem?
Solution	Is the proposed solution creative, feasible, and will it address the problem?
Value Proposition	What is the unique selling point of your solution?
Market	Who is the target user for your solution?
Traction	How will you attract target users to your solution?
Competition	What existing solutions can solve the problem and why is yours unique?
Cost/Revenue	What is the cost structure and revenue potential for your solution?

Problem	What is the relevance and impact of the problem?
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Sub-questions

- What is the problem in 1-2 sentences
- What is the pain point that you are trying to solve?

Example

- **Problem:** Users struggle to find a balanced view of news because of biased reporting and personalized content. This makes it hard to get a full picture of any topic.
- **Pain Points:**
 - Public's trust in governments are impacted by news
 - Sources used to build up articles need to be verified to avoid legal implications for the journalist.

Solution	Is the proposed solution creative, feasible, and will it address the problem?
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Sub-questions

- How can you describe your solution in 1 sentence?
- How does your solution address the pain points?

Example

- **Solution:** A platform that curates balanced, cross-publisher news content on a specific topic, offering readers both 'for' and 'against' perspectives for informed decision-making.
- **Addressing pain points:**
 - **General public:** By providing balanced viewpoints from multiple publishers, the platform helps restore trust by reducing bias and offering a more comprehensive understanding of the topic.
 - **Researchers/Journalists:** The platform ensures that all sourced articles are from verified publishers, helping avoid legal implications and ensuring journalistic integrity.

Value Proposition	What is the unique selling point of your solution?
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Sub-questions

- Why is your solution creative and novel? Is it the first to be created for those users? Does it have features which your competitors do not have?

Example

- Cross-Publisher Aggregation
- For/Against Viewpoint Curation

Market	Who is the target user for your solution?
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Sub-questions

- Is there only one type of user that can use your solution?

Example

- General Public News Consumer
- Researchers/Journalists

Traction	How will you attract target users to your solution?
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Sub-questions

- Is there only one way to get to the target users? Who influences the decisions of those users the most?

Example

- General Public News Consumer -- Search Engine Optimisation
- Researchers/Journalists -- Researcher mailing lists/Linkedin/Researcher Forums

Competition	What existing solutions can solve the problem and why is yours unique?
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Sub-questions

- Which other applications are available for users and they either fully or partially solve your problem?
- What features and/or design do you have in your solution that will make users go for it and not for your competitors?

Example

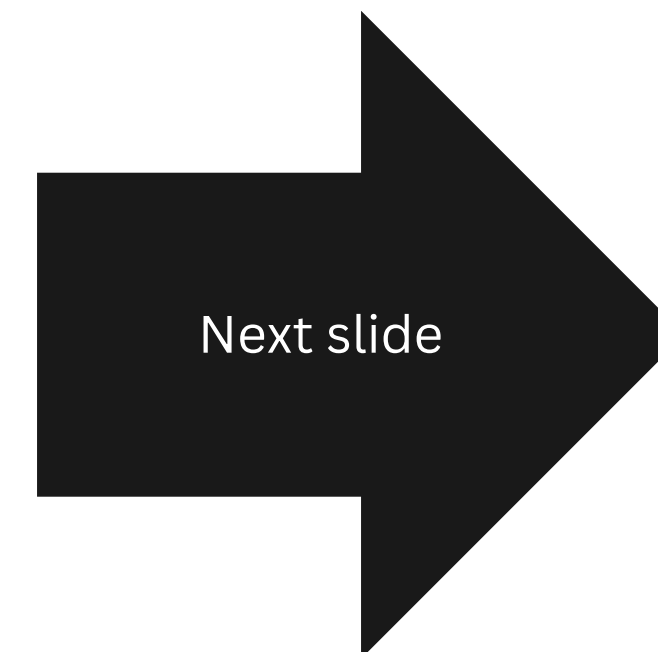
Product	Explicit Categoratisation	Source Verification
Google News	No	No
Flipboard	No	No
AllSides	Yes	No
Your solution	Yes	Yes

Cost/Revenue	What is the cost structure and revenue potential for your solution?
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Sub-questions

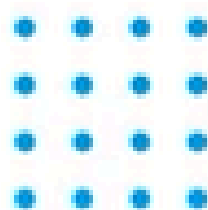
- Assuming you had 5000£ for fund the implementation, deployment, and maintenance of your solution, how would spend that money over the next year?
- How do you expect your solution to generate revenue if it was a running business?

Example

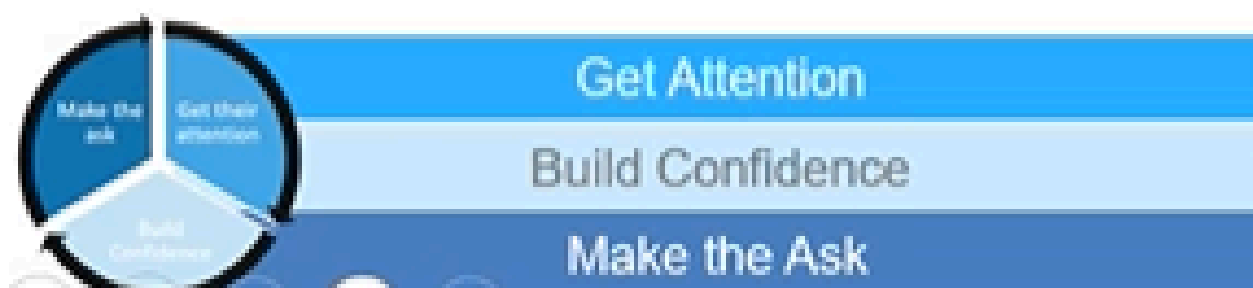
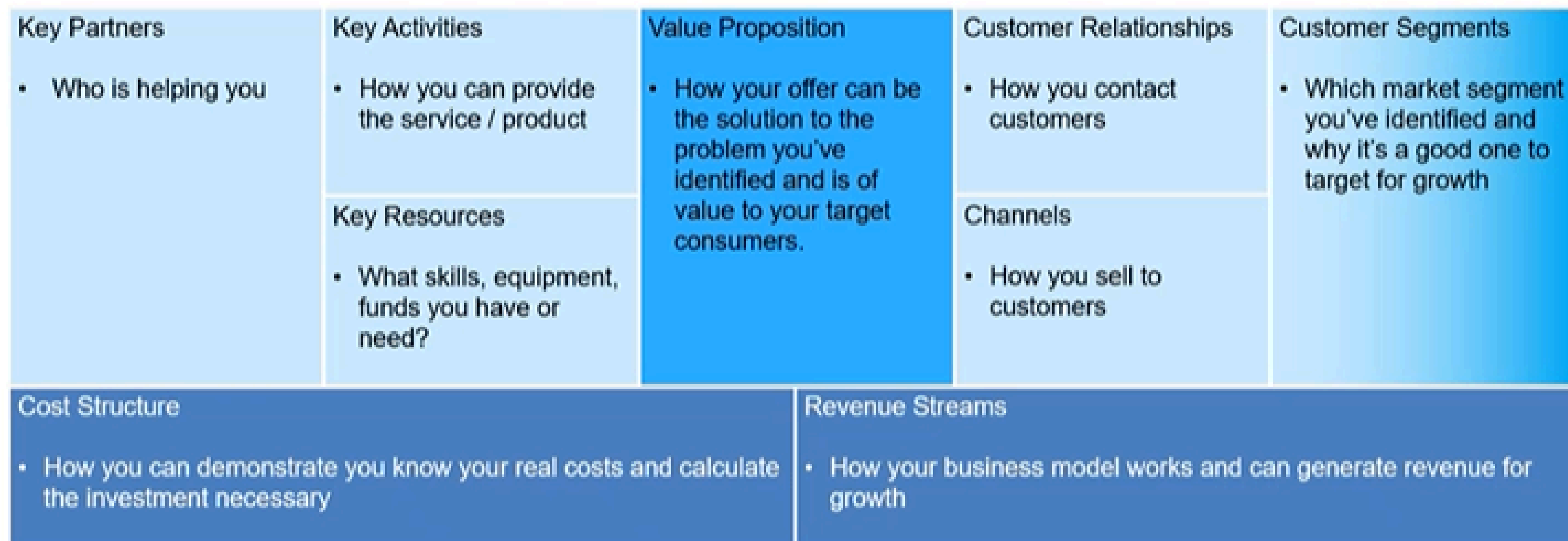


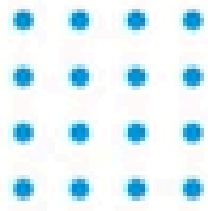
Cost Structure/Revenue Potential Example

Quarter	Funding Available (£)	Cost Structure (£)	Revenue Potential (£)
Q1	£1250	- Platform Development: £800- Hosting & Servers: £300- Marketing: £150	- Ad Revenue: £300- Initial Subscribers: £200
Q2	£1250	- Content Acquisition: £400- Maintenance & Support: £500- Marketing: £350	- Increased Ad Revenue: £500- More Subscribers: £300
Q3	£1250	- Content Curation & AI Training: £700- Maintenance: £300- Marketing: £250	- Premium Features: £600- Ad Revenue Growth: £500
Q4	£1250	- Scaling Infrastructure: £600- Ongoing Marketing: £400- Maintenance: £250	- Potential Partnerships: £700- Subscription Growth: £600



HOW CAN THE BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS HELP?





LAYOUT & DESIGN

Choose a position for your title and logo and never move them.

- Changing your title and logo position can distract your audience and look sloppy.

Maintain always the same title, colour and size for your titles.

Pick a font and one only.

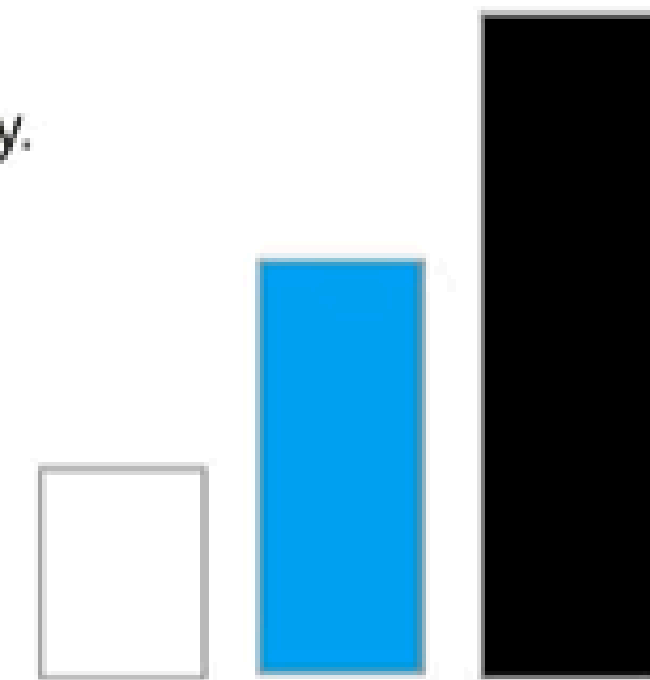
Avoid using too many colours. A palette of 3-4 maximum is advised.

Think about your colours – Green means good, Red means bad.

Use images and diagrams where possible

Signpost using colour changes or logos

Break up text into logical blocks.



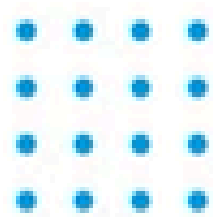
Simple 3 Colour Palette

Tip : Don't cram too much onto one slide. Let your layout breath.

<u>Section</u>	<u>Where to find its content in <u>your</u> previous submissions and resources?</u>
Problem	Your chosen case study brief + your own research
Solution	Your functional and non-functional requirements
Value Proposition	Your functional and non-functional requirements
Market	Use case diagram + target users from case study brief
Traction	Your own research (example given in the lecture slides)
Competition	Your own research (example given in the lecture slides)
Cost/Revenue	Your own research (example given in the lecture slides)

Pitching Tips -- from STEAMHouse Incubator

[Link](#)



WHAT IS A PITCH AND WHY BOTHER?

A brief, impactful synopsis of your proposition, your plans, traction to date, ability to deliver and a clear “ask”

Ideally delivered in person (virtual or face-to-face) - but easily understandable if read remotely.

Often essential to raise money.

Investors can
see what they
are buying

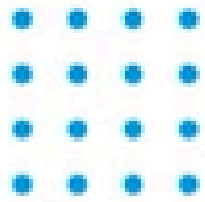
Investors can
see who they
are backing

You can
discover
possible backers

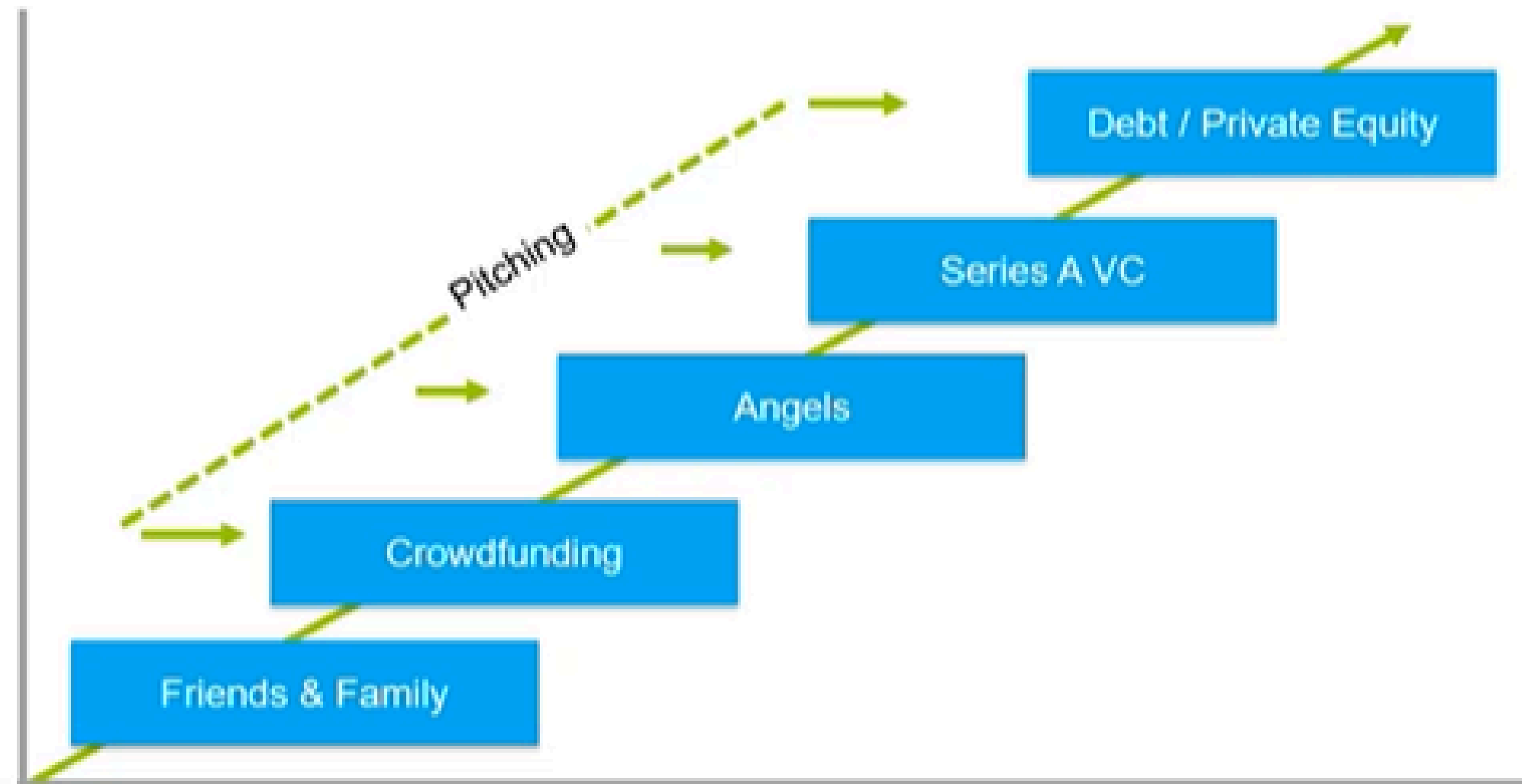
Subjects your
proposition to a
robust market
test

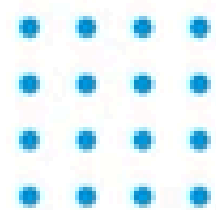
Helps you
refine, focus
and streamline
your ideas

Tip : Concentrate on a good pitch deck –Everything else follows



WHEN DO YOU NEED TO PITCH?



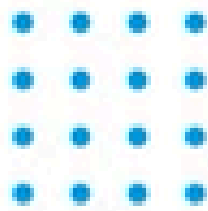


WHO ARE YOU PITCHING TO?

Potential investors, backers, mentors. From friends to angels to funds and institutions. Motivations vary, so think about your audience. They may all think a bit differently

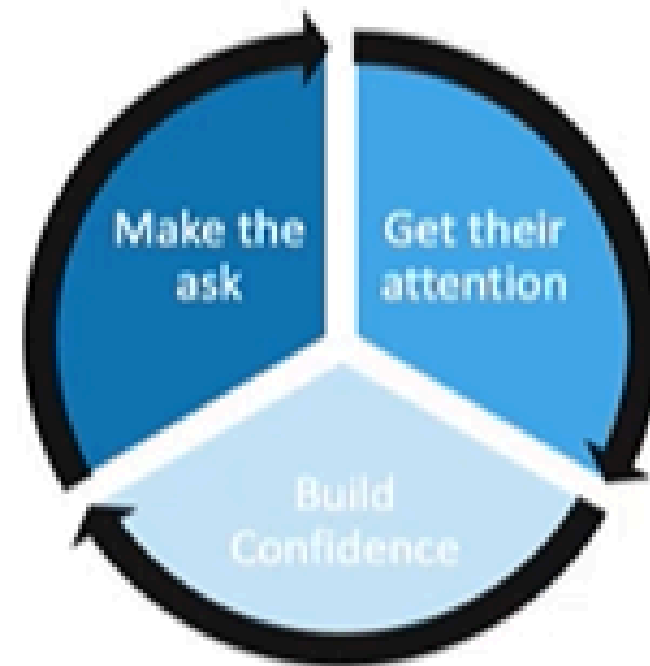


Do your homework – find out their names, thesis, funds, portfolio companies



THE NARRATIVE ARC

Everybody loves a good story. Stories are how we have communicated for millennia. So tell a simple story. Each point should flow logically from one to another. Give your pitch a “narrative arc”



GET THEIR ATTENTION

Highlight the opportunity. Explain why your concept is different and adds value.

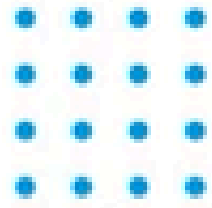
BUILD THEIR CONFIDENCE

Demonstrate they can have confidence in you making the business a success.

MAKE THE ASK

What do you need from them, why, what will it unlock, and why now?

Tip : Test your simple story on friends and family and check it flows.



GETTING THEIR ATTENTION

KEEP THE MESSAGING SIMPLE. DON'T OVERPLAY IT.

PURPOSE / MOTIVATION

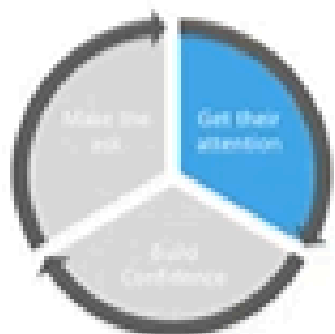
Use a clear mission statement or descriptor.
Avoid vagueness, jargon, cliché and over-exaggeration
Explain what motivates you and why?

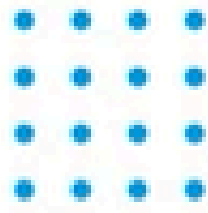
THE PROBLEM / OPPORTUNITY

Explain the market gap your proposition addresses

THE SOLUTION (VALUE PROPOSITION)

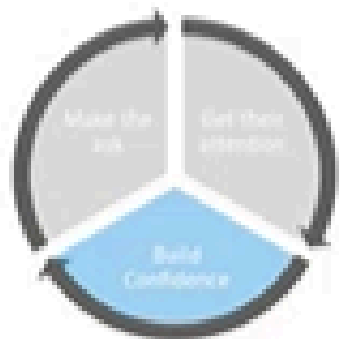
Explain how your product / service address this gap
What customer segments are you targeting?
Why will your value proposition appeal to them?





BUILDING CONFIDENCE

KNOW YOUR MARKET. TALK TO EXPERTS



MARKET & COMPETITION

Define the market and illustrate size, segments, trends and insights. Identify your key competitors and how you differentiate

ROUTE TO MARKET (CUSTOMER CHANNELS & RELATIONSHIPS)

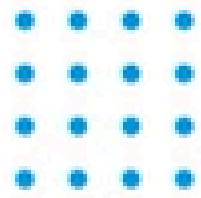
Show how you plan to access, understand and sell to customers. Through which channels, are you planning to grow?

OPERATIONAL DELIVERY (ACTIVITIES, PARTNERS, RESOURCES)

How are you going to make your product / deliver your service? What resources, support, partners can you access?

TEAM

What is your experience?
Who else is supporting you / who do you need?
How will this team deliver success?



FINANCIALS

Explain your business model? How do you charge?
What is your 3 / 5 year revenue / income plan?

INVESTMENT/ "THE ASK"

What is the money for?
What are you going to spend the money on, and how
will that accelerate your success?

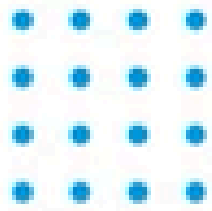
SUMMARY

Make it compelling.
Summarize the key take away from each slide
Provide a time bounded reason to invest

MAKE THE ASK

ALWAYS STAY CONSISTENT WITH THE NARRATIVE ARC





REHEARSAL & DELIVERY

Practice makes perfect - every time, you pitch you get better

Practice on family and friends

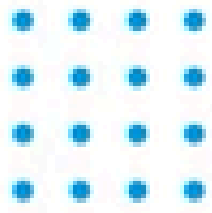
Iterate (repeat & improve) until you hone your core message

On the day

- Be confident and enthusiastic
- Don't waffle
- Answer the questions directly, good or bad!



Tip : Enthusiasm & humour makes people supportive



KEY TAKEAWAYS

A good pitch
improves your
chance of success

Think about your
audience and their
priorities

Tell a simple,
clear story

Have a clear
structure with a
narrative arc

Get their attention,
build their
confidence and
make the ask

Keep the format,
clean and
professional

Practice &
iterate

Be enthusiastic
& honest

Good Luck!

AI Tools at BCU: Student Guidelines



AI tools Decision Tree

